

Philipp Hilbert. *Payment systems product leader turned collection experience architect.*

Positioning, ten years owning complex payment and workflow products end-to-end, now ready to make debt resolution as frictionless as modern checkout.

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§ WHY RIVERTY

Riverty's Human Centric Collection strategy is a concrete product thesis, not a marketing line: it bets that transparent, self-directed repayment journeys retain more consumer goodwill than enforcement-heavy processes and that this translates directly to recovery rates. The job description's emphasis on self-service scalability and AI-supported decisioning signals that Riverty is willing to invest in the infrastructure to prove that thesis, not just announce it. That combination – social mission backed by a real product engineering commitment – is rare in the receivables space. *That is exactly the environment where a systems-minded PM with a payments background compounds fastest.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

Direct experience inside a receivables or collections business is not on my CV. What I do bring is ten years of product ownership across regulated payment flows, financial platform design, and the operational complexity of B2B SaaS in insurance, public-sector data, and defence – environments where compliance, auditability, and stakeholder alignment are not optional. The mechanic transfers directly: structuring decision logic, making it configurable for different debtor types, and reducing manual steps are problems I have solved before, just upstream of the collection event.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, continuous development assistance
- **GPT**, discovery synthesis and stakeholder document drafting
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy interface work
- **Gamma.app**, structured product presentations
- **n8n**, multi-agent and automation workflow design
- **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted development environment

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Jenkins, Bitbucket, MicroStrategy, REST APIs, Redpanda, Docker, GitOps pipelines, CGM API integration, Shopware, Ionic, AngularJS.

§ SIDE PROJECT

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A group-based P2P payment product built from zero, later acquired and operated by Sparkasse.

- Designed and shipped a P2P backbone for group settlement, covering full UX/UI design and mobile app prototype.
- Architected PSP integration covering edge-case handling in consumer payment flows.
- Built end-to-end from concept through production to a successful acquisition event.
- Direct precedent for Riverty's self-service payment journeys: same problem domain, consumer-facing, regulated, requiring zero-friction UX over complex financial plumbing.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT RIVERTY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the collections operations team, audit existing installment journey KPIs and drop-off points, and map the current decision logic for payment arrangement types to understand which constraints are business rules and which are technical debt.

WEEK 2

Slice and validate.

Run structured discovery sessions with operations, legal, and data to surface the highest-friction manual process steps and validate one candidate automation hypothesis against real case volumes.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Deliver the first prioritised backlog slice with the engineering team, establish a cadence for KPI review, and document configuration parameters so other product teams and operational units can apply payment logic without requiring PM involvement each time.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Riverty hiring team,

Debt resolution is one of the few financial product categories where the experience design directly determines the outcome – not just user satisfaction, but recovery rates. Riverty's Human Centric Collection strategy is a genuine product bet on that claim, and the fact that you are investing in scalable, automated, self-service payment infrastructure to back it up suggests the organisation is willing to do the hard systems work, not just the brand work. That is why this role caught my attention.

My background is in payment and workflow product management in regulated environments. At Kvitt Payment Solutions, a company I founded and built from zero, I designed and shipped a group-based P2P payment product including PSP integration, consumer payment UX, and all the edge-case handling that entails – before it was acquired and taken over by Sparkasse. At Emil Group I owned an InsurTech SaaS platform where the core challenge was exactly what this role describes: translating complex regulatory and operational requirements into configurable, scalable modules that different client types could apply independently, without engineering involvement. I rebuilt sprint discipline, split a bloated team into accountable Scrum units, and regained client trust through structured product communication. The mechanics of that work –

modelling decision logic, exposing configuration surfaces, reducing manual process steps – transfer directly to the Installments and Payments domain.

My more recent roles have sharpened the data and automation side. At the Federal Employment Agency I introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation on a public analytics platform, served as Deputy IT Security Officer, and standardised CI/CD across the stack. At Rohde and Schwarz I owned a data management platform inside the European defence programme FCAS, reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD, and delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end – requirements through implementation through rollout. I bring genuine technical fluency, not just the ability to relay requirements between business and engineering.

On the AI and automation side, I work daily with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, n8n for multi-agent workflow design, and rapid prototyping tools including Lovable and Framer. I treat these as real execution tools, not capability signals. When the job description refers to KI-gestützte Entscheidungen as part of future-proofing the payment product, I have a concrete idea of what that means in practice – automated decision routing, configurable scoring thresholds, audit-ready output – because I have shipped adjacent systems.

I am based in Berlin, speak German as a native language, and work at C2 level in English across written and verbal communication. I am available to start within four weeks of an offer. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the specifics of your current payment journey challenges and how I might contribute.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with close to ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows and regulatory requirements into scalable, automated software systems. Background spans payment product design, B2B SaaS platform delivery in regulated industries, public-sector data platforms, and AI data infrastructure. Comfortable owning products end-to-end – from discovery and prioritisation through engineering collaboration and KPI-driven iteration – in environments where requirements are incomplete and cross-functional alignment is the hardest problem. Technically fluent, low ego, high agency.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Payment flow and financial process product design
 - Complex regulatory requirements translated into configurable product logic
 - Scalable self-service and automation-first product thinking
 - Cross-functional stakeholder alignment without direct authority
 - Data-driven prioritisation and KPI-led iteration
 - Workflow automation and AI-assisted product execution
 - Backlog discipline, sprint management, and delivery ownership
 - Workshop facilitation across technical and non-technical audiences
 - Founder-level pragmatism in resource-constrained environments
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout – the same ownership model expected for Installments and Payments
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD; demonstrates capability to drive automation and process efficiency gains
- Led cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA without direct line authority
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated datasets with transparent evaluation concepts (SafeAI, ExplainableAI)
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week what had been outstanding for over a year

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, reducing manual process steps in a public-sector data platform – directly applicable to payment process automation

- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage in a regulated environment
- Delivered new analytics features including labour shortage indicators and flexible regional comparison tooling
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Translated complex regulatory and operational requirements into configurable, scalable modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation – the core capability required for installment logic design
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Rebuilt sprint discipline: split a bloated 17-person team into focused Scrum units with clear ownership and deputy structures
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, recovering delivery predictability
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and document storage under tight deadlines
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, requiring deep API dependency management
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity including legacy APIs and external database constraints

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder and CFO

- Designed and shipped a group-based P2P payment product from zero: full UX/UI design, PSP integration, consumer payment flows, and edge-case handling
- Built mobile app prototype; product was later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

- Direct precedent for self-service consumer payment journey design in a regulated context

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner

- Owned a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware, with a USP of sub-two-minute setup requiring no technical knowledge from the user
- Served as deputy IT security officer; responsible for security architecture and compliance posture

ADDITIONAL EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Proxy Product Owner – AOK Health Insurance ITSCare (2019–2020): Migrated internal webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policies.

Product Owner – COVID-19 Data Platform, Bundesdruckerei (2021): RKI projects DIM and DESH; secure data structures and identity management.

Co-Founder and Head of Digital – Smart Soil Technologies (2016–2021): Full digital infrastructure establishment, financial and investment planning, ERP introduction.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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